THE UNIVERSITY OF SYDNEY

Change Management Plan

Introduction

Change management (CM) is the structured approach to moving individuals, teams and the organisation from a current state to a desired future state. It focuses on how people adopt a change, not on building the technology itself (The University of Sydney, 2026). Project management asks *"Is the system built and working?"*; change management asks *"Are people actually using it?"*. Its purpose is to make sure an IT investment delivers its benefits, and projects with excellent CM are reported to be six times more likely to meet their objectives (The University of Sydney, 2026).

This plan supports **Lyra Impact Hub**, proposed in *Governance & Proposal*. The Hub links LMS activity and assessment data with Lyra usage to produce automated learning-impact evidence, educator insights and quarterly business review (QBR) reports. The build is modest; the harder change is behavioural. Customer success staff must stop hand-building reports, engineers must own a new data product, academics must trust and act on analytics, and university privacy and IT teams must approve new data flows.

The plan combines **Kotter's 8-step model** (Kotter, 1996) to build organisation-wide momentum with **ADKAR** (Hiatt, 2006) to move each person from awareness to reinforcement. Table 1 shows how both are sequenced across the project and who owns each phase.

Table 1. Change roadmap

Phase and timing	Kotter steps	ADKAR focus	Key change actions	Owner
1. Prepare Nov–Dec 2026	1 Urgency, 2 Coalition, 3 Vision	Awareness	Share conversion data (2 of 9 pilots); form change team and champions; agree vision	CEO (sponsor)
2. Engage Jan–Feb 2027	4 Communicate, 5 Remove barriers	Desire, Knowledge	Launch communications; co-design reports; standard data-sharing agreement; training	Head of Growth (change owner)
3. Pilot Semester 1 2027	6 Short-term wins	Ability	Hub live at two early-adopter universities; coaching; first evidence-based QBR	Customer Success Lead
4. Scale and embed Jul–Dec 2027	7 Consolidate, 8 Anchor in culture	Reinforcement	Roll out to all customers; retire manual QBR template; add impact KPIs to every squad	Head of Growth and CEO

Change vision and objectives

> ***Vision:*** *Every Lyra conversation with a university is backed by trustworthy evidence of learning impact – so academics know where students struggle, universities invest with confidence, and our team spends its time improving learning rather than compiling spreadsheets.*

The vision links directly to Lyra's mission of making course materials genuinely navigable: evidence shows whether that mission is being achieved. It is deliberately short so that every staff member can repeat it, which is Kotter's test of a clear vision (Kotter, 1996).

The change management process has five objectives. Each has a target that is measured in the final section of this plan.

Table 2. Change management objectives

Objective	Target
O1 Awareness and buy-in	All Lyra staff can explain why the Hub matters (pulse survey average of 4 out of 5 or higher) by February 2027
O2 Internal adoption	100% of QBRs and pilot evaluations produced through the Hub, and manual spreadsheet reports retired, by September 2027
O3 Academic adoption	60% of unit coordinators in licensed units use the dashboard at least fortnightly during semester by the end of 2027
O4 Trust and compliance	Data-sharing agreements signed with every pilot university before go-live, with zero privacy incidents
O5 Business outcome	Pilot-to-licence conversion rises from 22% (2 of 9) to at least 50% of 2027 pilots, supporting eight licences and 90% renewal

Change drivers and impact analysis

Five drivers make this change necessary now:

- **Competitive advantage** – only two of nine pilots have converted, and LMS incumbents are adding generic AI analytics. Proven impact is what differentiates Lyra.
- **Customer demand** – university executives need outcome evidence to justify spending, especially given sector scrutiny of generative AI (Lodge et al., 2023).
- **Efficiency improvement** – each QBR takes about two days of scarce customer success time.

- **Regulatory compliance** – the *Privacy Act 1988* (Cth) and the NSW *PPIP Act 1998* require student data to be handled lawfully and transparently, which ad-hoc spreadsheet exports cannot guarantee.
- **Financial** – a gross margin above 70% needs visibility of inference cost per licence.

Table 3. Impact analysis

Area	Current state	Future state	Impact
Processes	QBRs built by hand; pilot success criteria agreed informally	Reports generated automatically; success measures agreed at pilot kick-off; data-sharing agreement in every contract	High
Technology	Usage data sits in app logs and spreadsheets	LMS data connectors, a de-identified analytics store and an upgraded educator dashboard	Medium
People	Customer success staff compile reports; few academics use the dashboard	Customer success staff act as evidence-based advisers; academics act on struggle-topic insights; new data analyst role	High
Culture	Evaluation data used only for model quality; impact seen as a sales job	Every squad shares ownership of customer learning outcomes	Medium–High

Stakeholder analysis

Stakeholders were identified from Lyra's organisation chart and the customer segments in the Business Model Canvas. Table 4 maps the impact on each group, its influence over success, its expected resistance and the engagement strategy. The highest priority groups are those with high impact and high resistance – **academics** and **university IT and privacy officers** – because without their agreement no data flows and the Hub has nothing to measure.

Table 4. Change impact map

Stakeholder	Impact of the change	Influence	Resistance	Engagement strategy
Board and executive team	Fund and sponsor the change; little change to daily work	High	Low	Monthly progress through the Technology & Risk Committee; visible sponsorship by the CEO
Customer success and sales (5)	New reporting workflow and new analytical skills	High	Medium	Co-design report templates; change champion in the team; early hands-on training

Stakeholder	Impact of the change	Influence	Resistance	Engagement strategy
Engineering (16)	Build and run a new data pipeline	High	Medium	CTO frames the Hub as a core product capability; dedicated squad; recognised in objectives
Learning designers (5)	Turn struggle topics into teaching advice	Medium	Low	Involve as co-designers of insight wording
Academics and unit coordinators	New dashboard and insights in their teaching	High	High	Opt-in by unit; aggregate-only data; Academic Advisory Board endorsement; 15-minute onboarding
DVC (Education) and teaching and learning centres	Receive evidence reports for licence decisions	High	Low	Agree success measures at pilot kick-off; review results in QBRs
University IT and privacy officers	Approve data flows and configure LTI Advantage	High	Medium–High	Pre-completed privacy impact assessment; standard data-sharing agreement; integration team support
Students	Their data is used in aggregate; option to opt out	Medium	Low–Medium	Clear in-app privacy notice; consult student association

Communication plan

Communication follows two principles from the lecture: explain the *why*, not just the *what*, and keep channels two-way so concerns surface early (The University of Sydney, 2026). Messages are tailored to each group in Table 5, and every channel includes a way to reply, such as Q&A sessions, a Slack channel or an in-product feedback button.

Table 5. Communication plan

Stakeholder	Objective	Methods	Frequency	Owner
Board and executive	Keep sponsorship; track benefits	Committee report; board paper	Monthly; quarterly	CEO
All Lyra staff	Awareness of why and progress	CEO all-hands launch; #impact-hub Slack channel; demo days	Launch, then fortnightly	CEO
Customer success and sales	Desire and knowledge of the new workflow	Co-design workshops; stand-up check-ins; playbook	Weekly during pilot	Customer Success Lead
Engineering	Clear scope and ownership	Sprint reviews; architecture decision records	Fortnightly	CTO

Stakeholder	Objective	Methods	Frequency	Owner
Academics	Build trust; explain what data is and is not used	Two-minute video; FAQ; LMS announcement; faculty briefing; in-product tips	Semester start and mid-semester	Learning Design Lead with university T&L centre
DVC (Education) and T&L centres	Agree success measures; show results	Pilot kick-off workshop; QBR impact report	Kick-off, then quarterly	Head of Growth
University IT and privacy	Approve data flows	Privacy impact assessment pack; technical briefing	Before pilot, then as needed	Head of Trust & Compliance
Students	Transparency and choice	In-app privacy notice; help-centre article	First use each semester	Head of Trust & Compliance

Training and capacity Building

Training builds the *Knowledge* and *Ability* stages of ADKAR. Each group's needs were identified from the impact analysis, and delivery is kept short and practical because both Lyra staff and academics are time-poor.

Table 6. Training needs, delivery and support

Group	Training need	Delivery method	Support system
Customer success and sales	Reading impact reports, explaining their limits (association is not causation), running evidence-based QBRs	Two hands-on workshops using real pilot data; QBR role-plays	Playbook; champion buddy; weekly check-in
Engineering	Data pipeline, de-identification, LTI Advantage grade services	Internal tech talks; pair programming	Runbooks; architecture documents
Learning designers	Turning struggle topics into teaching recommendations	Co-design sessions	Template library
Academics	Reading the dashboard, acting on insights, privacy guardrails	Two-minute video; 15-minute faculty briefing; in-product walkthrough	Help centre; customer success contact; drop-in office hours
University IT staff	Configuring LTI Advantage and data flows	Technical onboarding session and documentation	Integration team support channel

Capacity building. Lyra will hire one data analyst to close the skills gap identified in AW3, and train one change champion in each team. Champions are respected peers who answer questions and pass on feedback; this change agent network speeds adoption through peer influence (The University of Sydney, 2026).

Measurement. Training is evaluated with Kirkpatrick's four levels (Kirkpatrick & Kirkpatrick, 2016): *Reaction* (post-session rating of 4 out of 5 or higher), *Learning* (a short quiz and a QBR role-play assessed by the Customer Success Lead), *Behaviour* (share of reports produced through the Hub and dashboard use by academics) and *Results* (pilot conversion and renewal).

Resistance Management

Resistance is the norm rather than the exception (The University of Sydney, 2026), so it is planned for rather than treated as failure. Table 7 lists the main sources of resistance, the psychological response behind each, and the strategy to address it.

Table 7. Sources of resistance and strategies

Source	Who	Psychological response	Strategy
Fear of surveillance and loss of academic autonomy	Academics, students	Fear of the unknown	Aggregate-only results (10 or more students); no ranking of staff or students; opt-in by unit; publish a plain-English 'what we collect' page; Academic Advisory Board endorsement
Loss of craft and fear of automation	Customer success staff	Loss aversion	Co-design the templates; keep an editable narrative section; frame the Hub as freeing time for advice; commit that no roles will be cut
Competing priorities	Engineers	Status quo bias	Dedicated squad; CTO sponsorship; Hub work counted in team objectives; show the link to company targets
Workload and risk aversion	University IT and privacy officers	Status quo bias	Pre-completed privacy impact assessment; standard agreement; Lyra's integration team does the configuration
Doubt about the evidence	Academics, DVC (Education)	Cognitive dissonance	Transparent method with stated limits; independent review by the Academic Advisory Board
Change fatigue	Time-poor academics	Fear of extra workload	Launch at semester start, never mid-assessment; onboarding kept to 15 minutes

Three further tactics support these strategies. First, the **Kübler-Ross change curve** predicts a dip in morale and productivity during the pilot (e.g., "our spreadsheets work fine"), so coaching and support are front-loaded in Phase 3 and early wins are shared to rebuild confidence. Second, **Diffusion of Innovation** theory (Rogers, 2003) guides the rollout: the pilot starts with early-adopter faculties, their results

are used as social proof for the majority, and laggards receive one-to-one support. Third, sceptical people with high influence, such as a senior academic, are identified early and invited into co-design so that critics become contributors.

Resistance issues are recorded in a change log reviewed fortnightly by the Head of Growth. Any issue unresolved after two reviews is escalated to the Technology & Risk Committee.

Cultural Considerations

Company Culture before the change

The Competing Values Framework identifies four culture types (Cameron & Quinn, 2011): **Clan** (collaborative, family-like), **Adhocracy** (innovative, experimental, risk-taking), **Market** (competitive, focused on results and customers) and **Hierarchy** (controlled, process-driven).

Lyra's current culture is mainly an **Adhocracy** with **Clan** features. *About the Organisation* describes a company that is deliberately small and cross-functional, where engineers, learning designers and former academics share squads. The flat structure, rapid experimentation and engineering-led product decisions are typical of an adhocracy, while the small team and shared squads give it a collaborative, clan-like feel. Lyra also has a strong evidence habit, because product claims are settled by evaluation data rather than enthusiasm.

However, that evidence habit points **inwards**, at model quality, rather than **outwards**, at customer outcomes. Success is measured by shipping features, and proving value to universities is treated as the sales team's job. This is the cultural root of the challenge identified in AW3.

Desired company culture after the change

The target is an **Adhocracy–Market blend**, which we call *evidence-led innovation*. Lyra keeps its innovative, experimental strengths but adopts the Market quadrant's external focus on results: every squad sees impact metrics, and success means measurable outcomes for universities and students, not features shipped.

This blend is justified for three reasons. First, Lyra's FY2027 objectives (eight licences, 90% renewal and a 70% margin) are market measures, so the culture should value what the strategy measures. Second, university customers buy on evidence, so outcome focus is directly linked to revenue. Third, competition from LMS incumbents means Lyra must prove a difference rather than claim one.

The Clan values of trust and privacy must be kept. A purely Market culture could create pressure to overstate impact, which would damage the trust Lyra depends on. The rule is therefore simple: **we only claim what the data supports**.

Bridging the gap

McKinsey's 7S model is used to align the elements that shape culture, with shared values at the centre (The University of Sydney, 2026).

Table 8. Bridging actions using the McKinsey 7S model

7S element	Bridging action
Shared values	Add "We prove our impact – honestly" to Lyra's company values, next to privacy
Strategy and systems	Put one impact KPI in every squad's quarterly objectives and on the team dashboard
Style	The CEO opens each all-hands meeting with a customer impact result, modelling the new focus
Structure	The Head of Growth is accountable for impact; each engineer attends one QBR per quarter
Staff and skills	Hire a data analyst and deliver the training in Table 6
Recognition	Celebrate the first renewal won with Hub evidence (Kotter step 8: anchor the change)

Success metrics and monitoring

Adoption is measured with a balanced set of **leading** KPIs, which give early warning while the change is happening, and **lagging** KPIs, which confirm that the business benefit was realised. Each KPI in Table 9 maps to an objective from Table 2 and has a baseline, target, data source, frequency and owner.

Table 9. Change adoption KPIs

KPI (objective)	Type	Baseline	Target	Data source	Frequency	Owner
ADKAR pulse score (O1)	Leading	New	4.0 / 5 or higher	Staff pulse survey	Monthly	Head of Finance & People
Training completion (O1)	Leading	0%	100% of staff; 80% of pilot coordinators	HR and LMS records	Fortnightly	Learning Design Lead
Data-sharing agreements signed (O4)	Leading	0	Every pilot university before go-live	Contract register	Monthly	Head of Trust & Compliance
Reports produced through the Hub (O2)	Leading	0%	100% by Sep 2027	Hub audit log	Monthly	Customer Success Lead

KPI (objective)	Type	Baseline	Target	Data source	Frequency	Owner
QBR preparation time (O2)	Lagging	~2 days	Under 2 hours	Time logs	Quarterly	Customer Success Lead
Coordinators using dashboard fortnightly (O3)	Leading	~15%	60%	Product analytics	Weekly in semester	Head of Product
Academics who trust Lyra's data use (O3)	Leading	Pilot-start survey	75% agree	Academic survey	Each semester	Head of Trust & Compliance
Privacy incidents (O4)	Guardrail	0	0	Incident register	Monthly	Head of Trust & Compliance
Pilot-to-licence conversion (O5)	Lagging	22%	50% or higher	CRM	Quarterly	Head of Growth
Licence renewal rate (O5)	Lagging	No renewals yet	90%	CRM	Quarterly	CEO

Escalation threshold. If any leading KPI is more than 20% below target for two consecutive months, the Head of Growth escalates it to the Technology & Risk Committee with a recovery plan.

Feedback mechanisms. Five channels collect feedback:

- an in-product feedback button and one-question survey for academics;
- a fortnightly change champion meeting to surface issues from each team;
- the monthly ADKAR pulse survey, which shows *which* stage is the barrier – for example, low Ability scores trigger extra coaching rather than more communication;
- end-of-semester retrospectives with each pilot university; and
- a review of support-ticket themes and Academic Advisory Board advice each quarter.

Continuous improvement. Results feed the ITIL 4 continual improvement model (AXELOS, 2019), which asks: What is the vision? Where are we now? Where do we want to be? How do we get there? Take action. Did we get there? How do we keep the momentum going? In practice this is a monthly cycle: collect KPI and feedback data, diagnose the gap using ADKAR, agree an improvement action with an owner, and re-measure the next month. Actions are tracked in a continual improvement register owned by the Head of Growth. Once all targets have been met for two consecutive quarters, the KPIs move into Lyra's normal business reporting, which signals that the change has become *the way we do things* (Kotter, 1996). Benefit tracking then continues under the monitoring framework in AW12.

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